

Common Windows Server Event Logs

Essential Events to Monitor

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Introduction

Windows Server generates thousands of event log entries daily. Knowing which events to monitor helps you quickly identify and resolve issues before they impact users. This guide covers the most important event logs and IDs that every IT administrator should watch.

How to Access Event Logs

Event Viewer

- 1. **Start Menu** → **Administrative Tools** → **Event Viewer**
- 2. Or type `eventvwr.msc` in Run dialog
- 3. Navigate to **Windows Logs** for main categories

Critical System Events

Boot and Shutdown Issues

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
6005	System	Event Log Service Started	Normal - system boot
6006	System	Event Log Service Stopped	Normal - system shutdown
6008	System	Unexpected Shutdown	Investigate - possible crash
6013	System	System Uptime	Monitor for stability

Hardware and Driver Problems

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
7000	System	Service Failed to Start	Check service dependencies
7026	System	Boot-Start Driver Failed	Update or reinstall driver
41	System	System Rebooted Without Shutdown	Check hardware/power issues

Security Events to Monitor

Account Management

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
4720	Security	User Account Created	Review for unauthorized accounts
4726	Security	User Account Deleted	Verify authorized deletion
4738	Security	User Account Changed	Monitor privilege changes

Logon Events

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
4624	Security	Successful Logon	Normal activity
4625	Security	Failed Logon	Monitor for brute force attacks
4634	Security	Account Logged Off	Normal activity
4648	Security	Logon with Explicit Credentials	Review for suspicious activity

Privilege Changes

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
4728	Security	User Added to Security Group	Verify authorization
4732	Security	User Added to Local Group	Check local admin additions
4756	Security	User Added to Universal Group	Review group membership

Application and Service Events

Common Application Issues

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
1000	Application	Application Crash	Investigate failing application
1001	Application	Application Hang	Check application performance
1002	Application	Application Error	Review application logs

IIS Web Server (if applicable)

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
2	System	IIS Service Started	Normal startup
3	System	IIS Service Stopped	Check if unexpected

Active Directory Events

Domain Controller Health

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
1311	Directory Service	KCC Errors	Check replication issues
1388	Directory Service	Replication Errors	Investigate network/DNS
5805	Directory Service	Authentication Failures	Monitor for attacks

DNS Issues

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
4013	DNS Server	DNS Server Started	Normal startup
4015	DNS Server	DNS Server Stopped	Check if unexpected
4000	DNS Server	DNS Query Errors	Investigate DNS problems

Network and Connectivity

Network Issues

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
5719	System	No Domain Controller Available	Critical - check network/DNS
5722	System	Session Setup Failed	Check domain trust
8	System	System Shutdown Initiated	Normal if planned

Performance and Resource Events

Memory and Disk Issues

Event ID	Log	Description	Action Required
2019	System	Not Enough Server Storage	Add more disk space
2020	System	Server Out of Memory	Add more RAM
15	System	File System Corrupt	Run disk check

Event Log Levels

Understanding Severity Levels

Level	Icon	Description	Action Priority
Error	✖	Something failed	High - immediate attention
Warning	⚠	Potential problem	Medium - investigate soon
Information	i	Normal operation	Low - for reference
Critical	●	System instability	Urgent - immediate action

Remember: Regular monitoring of these event logs helps prevent small issues from becoming major problems. Focus on Critical and Error events first, then investigate Warning events that occur frequently.

This document is part of the Windows Server training materials by Dan Mill Training.